

FreeNAS is based on FreeBSD, which is a Unix-like open-source OS. FreeNAS is different from both, Linux and Windows. You should therefore bear in mind that using the OS as the backbone of your file storage is going to wipe out anything that might be on the hard drives you use. But there's also a bright side to it – FreeNAS itself requires no hard drive space for installation.

Download the FreeNAS ISO and insert a CD in your burner. If you don't already have software capable of burning an ISO image to a CD, download and install the free utility ISO Recorder. Once you've burned the image, put the CD in your NAS box's optical drive, restart your computer and boot FreeNAS from the CD.

Install FreeNAS on a USB thumb drive

We're going to set up our NAS to boot from a USB thumb drive so we don't limit our upgrade options.

- ▶ Plug a thumb drive into the NAS box's USB port when the FreeNAS Console Setup menu appears.
- ▶ Choose the menu item "Install/Upgrade to a hard drive/flash device, etc."
- ▶ When prompted next, choose the first option: "Install 'embedded' OS on HDD/Flash/USB."
- ▶ Choose the optical drive containing the FreeNAS ISO image and hit Enter.
- ▶ Now select the USB thumb drive on which you want to install the OS.

Configure your network settings

- ▶ After you've installed the operating system on the thumb drive, remove the CD and reboot your NAS box.
- ▶ When your NAS box has rebooted, choose the first item from the Console Setup menu "Assign Interface".
- ▶ Unplug the NAS box's ethernet cable and choose the OS's Auto Detection option.
- ▶ When prompted, plug the ethernet cable back in and hit the Enter key.
- ▶ You'll get a message that reads "Detected link-up on interface XX," where "XX" is the name of your ethernet interface. Hit the Enter key again.
- ▶ The next screen will read "Configure OPT interface."
- ▶ Choose the option that reads "Finish and exit configuration" and hit the Enter key.

Now the next thing we need to do is set the LAN IP address. However before we can do that, we need to reboot the computer. You can do this by typing the number 7 and hitting Enter to reboot the computer.